

Rick Hull, Operations

<https://github.com/rickhull>

Objective

Seeking a role in operations, site reliability, or infrastructure where experience running live production systems, managing risk at high stakes, and building automation from scratch translates directly into reliability and operational excellence.

Key Qualifications

- Deep experience in DevOps, cloud infrastructure, and automation as code
- Proven ability to take ownership of systems and processes, stabilize, and improve them
- Hands-on operations mentality: show up, assess, act, iterate
- Track record of leading small teams in high-stakes, time-sensitive environments — both technical and physical
- Rapid adoption of unfamiliar technologies and domains
- Clear communication under pressure

Experience

High Performance Driving Instructor - Porsche Experience Center

2018 - 2024

- Delivered safety-critical instruction in a high-throughput environment managing students, vehicles, and track conditions simultaneously
- Built trust and situational awareness with diverse customers, adapting in real time to skill level, risk tolerance, and weather
- Operated within tightly controlled safety protocols while maximizing customer satisfaction — an exercise in operational precision

Senior Devops Engineer - Glassdoor

2015-2016

- Took ownership of the DevOps / Chef repo within one week, stabilizing deployments across a hybrid cloud environment (AWS + Rackspace)
- Drove adoption of immutable infrastructure as code, significantly increasing deployment reliability and repeatability
- Solely responsible for DevOps, deployment, systems administration, and security in a production environment serving millions of users
- Instrumental in launching a new Solr-based search platform across multiple cloud providers

Crew Chief - Special Events Network

2005, 2013

SEN produced outdoor cinema events (Movies Under the Stars) and grew the Caffeine & Octane car show from a local gathering into a major televised event with a national following.

First stint — Post-Katrina, Atlanta. Early days of Caffeine & Octane at the Wildwood location. Led 2-4 person crews setting up and operating a 40-foot inflatable rear-projection screen with sound system, generator, stakes, tiedowns, and safety protocols across multiple sites per week.

Second stint — While working at Planet Payment after returning from New York post-Sandy. Caffeine & Octane had grown into a major operation off Peachtree Industrial near I-285, with a TV show on a national network. Crew lead responsible for logistics, load planning, route optimization, and on-site troubleshooting of audio, video, and electrical systems.

Software Engineer - Cloudscaling

2013-2014

- Re-engineered primary REST API for improved consistency, predictability, and maintainability while maintaining backwards compatibility
- Built and maintained CI/CD infrastructure (Jenkins) for an OpenStack cloud platform composed of dozens of independent projects
- Solved infrastructure testing challenges: nested virtualization, network isolation, state cleanup, and test cycle optimization

Software Engineer - Planet Payment

2005-2013

Started in Atlanta, relocated to New York. After Hurricane Sandy (Sandy → month in Delaware → back to Atlanta), continued working from Atlanta until joining Cloudscaling. Moonlighted SEN briefly during the final year.

- Built the QA department and automation infrastructure from scratch
- Developed 50kLOC of automation libraries and tools in Ruby for testing financial transaction processing systems
- Created black-box regression test suites, load-testing clients, mock servers, and test harnesses for isolating system behavior
- Eliminated points of failure by introducing consistent development and deployment policies across the engineering organization

Skills

Operations & Infrastructure

- Linux system administration (Debian / Ubuntu > NixOS > Arch > Red Hat) *10+ years*
- AWS infrastructure as code (Rackspace, OpenStack)
- Configuration management: Chef, Ansible, SaltStack, Nix
- CI/CD: Jenkins, automation pipelines
- Monitoring, incident response, deployment reliability

Software Development

- Ruby *10+ years*, Python, Nix, Elixir / Erlang / BEAM
- TCP network programming, clients and servers
- Redis, PostgreSQL, MySQL
- Hashicorp stack, Solr, Zookeeper

Education

Tulane University School of Engineering

- B.S. Computer Science
- 3.6 Major GPA

Honors

- Distinguished Scholar Award *4 years*
- Consistently named to Dean's List *4 years*

- National Merit Scholar
- Lexmark Scholar

References available upon request